Wonder of You — Script

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Story overview

Wonder of You is a 15–25 minute first-person VR story told over one day in the life of a retired father who has lived with Alzheimer's disease for nearly ten years. The player is him. He believes it is an ordinary morning: his wife is at work, his daughter is a schoolgirl asleep down the hall. Neither is true.

The player learns the truth through what goes wrong, not through explanation. A clock that shows the wrong hour, a weekday that is really a weekend, a clinic with no one in it. In the middle of the day, three dream spaces carry his late wife's voice, saying what she never could while she was alive. At night, his grown daughter calls, and he asks for her mother.

Core idea: memory fades, but the shape of loving someone remains.

Format	First-person narrative VR, six acts
Runtime	15–25 minutes
Language	English (all dialogue, subtitles and in-world text)
Recurring motif	*The Wonder of You* by Elvis Presley, heard as a ringtone in Acts 1, 2 and 6

Characters

Character	Who they are	How the player meets them
Dad (the player)	A retired engineer in his seventies, living with Alzheimer's. Cap, glasses, cane, a cardigan and a lanyard with his house keys. Gentle, polite, easily puzzled. He still lives inside a morning from twenty years ago.	The player sees through his eyes and hears his inner voice.
The daughter, as a child	A schoolgirl with long dark hair, headphones and a backpack. This is the only version of her Dad still remembers.	A voice behind her bedroom door in Act 1.
The daughter, as an adult	Now in her thirties, working, married, living one town over. Hair up, scarf, tote bag. She holds herself together for him.	The phone call in Act 6.
The wife	Dad's wife since they were seventeen. She cared for him for years and has since died.	Two phone calls he imagines (Acts 1–2) and her voice in the dreams (Acts 3–5).
Nancy (unseen)	Dad's caregiver.	Named in Act 6.
Dr. Schrempp (unseen)	Dad's doctor.	Named in Act 6.

The daughter is designed twice on purpose. The player first meets the child Dad believes is down the hall, then the adult she really is. The gap between the two versions is the story.

Open question: the wife's and daughter's names are still placeholders on the phone screens.

Script

Stage directions are in italics. Lines marked *(V.O.)* are Dad's inner voice and play without subtitles.

Act 1 — Home, morning

INT. DAD'S BEDROOM — DAY. Soft light. Everything is in its place, with one or two details slightly off. Morning birdsong, distant traffic, the hum of the fridge.

A prompt floats beside the nightstand: "The clock on the nightstand." Dad picks up the clock. It reads 7:00 AM. Beside it, the phone lights up and starts to ring: The Wonder of You. The screen reads "Incoming call — [Wife]."

On the nightstand there is also a pill bottle. The player may take a pill or leave it.

WIFE (on the phone): Hey, darling. Today's your check-up. You haven't forgotten, have you? It's already past one. I booked you in for two. You should start heading out.

DAD: It's already one? Of course. I completely forgot. I'll head out soon.

The call ends. A new prompt appears: "You're going to be late. Don't forget your phone."

INT. HALLWAY. Dad passes his daughter's door and knocks.

DAD: Hey, you're going to be late for school. Come on, get your things together. I'll drive you in ten minutes.

No answer. He knocks again.

DAD: Did you hear me?

DAUGHTER (CHILD) (behind the door): Have you forgotten, Dad? It's the weekend. I don't have school today.

DAD: Is it? I'm sorry, I must have mixed it up. Sorry for waking you. Have a good weekend.

DAUGHTER (CHILD): You too, Dad. Don't forget your medication.

DAD (V.O., walking away): How did I get the day of the week wrong…

The front door can now be opened. Dad steps outside.

Act 2 — The clinic

INT. CLINIC CORRIDOR — DAY. Not his front step: a long, slightly too narrow clinic corridor. When he turns around, the door he came through is gone. Cold light flickers faintly. No one is here. Distant footsteps stop whenever he stops.

On the wall, a calendar shows a date that doesn't match the day he believes it is. On a board, a patient file has his name on it, partly covered.

A prompt: "Check your phone." The screen shows three missed calls from [Wife] and one message:

> Where are you? Why didn't you pick up our daughter? She's been waiting outside school for 40 minutes. What is going on?

Dad taps Call back. The ringtone plays twice, then she answers.

WIFE (on the phone): Oh, hi, darling. Are you at the clinic? I just saw a message from the doctor saying today's appointment was cancelled. I'm so sorry, I only just noticed. Work has been completely overwhelming. He said your prescription is ready, so I'll pick it up on my way home. Don't worry about it. I really have to go, I'm sorry. I'll call you after work. Bye.

She hangs up before he can answer.

DAD (V.O.): She's that busy? Is the clinic closed today? Why is there no one here?

A prompt: "You can leave now." He pushes open the exit door.

Sound note: in both of the wife's calls, her voice has a faint reverb and high-pass filter, just enough to feel unreal on a second listen. She died years ago. Dad is remembering these calls, or making them up.

Acts 3–5 — The dreams

Three dream spaces follow, one after another. There are no prompts and nothing to pick up. Dad can only walk toward a landmark in the distance. A few seconds in, his wife starts to speak, close beside him, a little ahead and to his left, as if she were walking with him. Her voice has no filter here.

Act 3 — The open field

EXT. ENDLESS GRASSLAND. The sky and the ground blend together, with no horizon. Far away, a small cabin with warm light in the window. Only wind and long grass.

Tone: bright and wondering, with something quiet underneath. She already knows how this ends.

WIFE (V.O.): I used to wonder what you saw in me. I'm serious. I used to lie awake and think: why me? Out of everyone, why did you keep choosing me? You never had a good answer. You'd just look at me. That look. As if the question itself confused you, as if the answer was too obvious for words. I hated that. I loved that.

I remember the night we got caught in the rain. We were walking back from that terrible movie, the one we argued about for two hours afterwards. It started pouring, we had no umbrella, and you just laughed. You threw your head back and laughed as if it was the funniest thing that had ever happened to you. I thought: I want to be near that for the rest of my life. That's it. That's the whole reason.

There's a song. You know the one. You used to hum it without knowing you were humming it. I never told you what it was called, because I liked that it was ours before it was anyone else's.

When you smile at me, I know the wonder of you.

I don't know if you still hear it somewhere. I don't know what's left. But I want you to know: whatever you remember, whatever you don't, you were the wonder. You always were. Not me. You.

Dad reaches the cabin. Fade.

Act 4 — The pool

INT. DRAINED POOL. Enclosed and heavy. Industrial pipes all around. The ceiling feels too low, then too high. Distant dripping and an echo that lasts too long. Faint light at the far end.

Tone: exhausted, honest, breaking apart. This is the hardest scene. Leave the pauses in.

WIFE (V.O.): There's something nobody tells you. It isn't the forgetting that breaks you. It's the moments in between, when you're still there. When you look at me and know my face but can't find my name, and I can see you searching, and you're so frightened, and all I can do is hold your hand and pretend I'm not frightened too.

I stopped sleeping. I started counting your pills. I started thinking terrible things. Quietly. Late at night.

I asked you once. You were having a good day. You knew who I was. I sat down next to you, took your hand and said: do you want to come with me, when it's time? Do you want us to go together?

You looked at me for a long time. Then you smiled, the smile I've known since we were seventeen, and you said: wherever you go, I'll follow.

I don't know if you understood what I was asking. I couldn't do it. I looked at you and I couldn't.

(pause)

There was a day, near the end, when you looked at me and said: I'm sorry, do I know you?

I said yes. I said, it's me. I said the name you gave me when we were nineteen. Do you remember—

You were very polite. You said: I'm sorry, I don't think so. And then you asked if I'd like some tea.

I said yes. I sat at our kitchen table and drank the tea you made me. I didn't say anything, and you didn't know that I was—

I don't know what I was. I don't have a word for it. I don't think there is one.

Dad reaches the light at the end of the pipes. Fade.

Act 5 — The sky

EXT. OPEN SKY. No ground in sight; he walks on something soft like cloud. Closed photo albums drift slowly past. Warm light. Ahead, a thick bank of cloud.

Tone: quiet and unresolved. She hasn't made peace with everything, but she has run out of road.

WIFE (V.O.): I keep telling myself I've made peace with it. Some days I almost believe it.

Our daughter called last week. She sounds like you when she laughs. Did you know that? The same rhythm. I don't know if she knows.

I think about her a lot. Whether she'll be okay. Whether you'll know her voice when she calls. Whether someday she'll say "Dad" and something in you will still recognise her, and move toward her.

I need that to be true. I know I don't get to need things anymore. I know. But—

That last morning, you didn't know me. You were kind. You held my hand because you could see I was in pain, and you were always kind to strangers. That's who you are. That's who you've always been.

And you hummed. You didn't know my face. You didn't know my name. But you held my hand and hummed. Not a real song, just a sound, the same sound you made every morning for thirty years without knowing it.

So maybe that's what's left when everything else goes. Not memory. Not names. Not faces. Just the shape of loving someone.

Still there. Still there.

I have to believe that.

Her voice stops. Dad walks the last few steps into the cloud in silence.

Act 6 — Home, night

INT. DAD'S HOME — NIGHT. The same rooms as the morning, now in warm, low light. Crickets outside. A clock ticking. It is very quiet.

DAD (V.O.): What just happened? What was all that… Finally home. Is anyone there? Is anyone there?

No one answers. The bedroom door down the hall stands open. The room behind it has been empty for years.

From the bedroom, the phone rings: The Wonder of You, louder and closer than before. A prompt: "Your phone." The screen reads "Incoming call — [Daughter]."

DAUGHTER (ADULT) (on the phone): Hi, Dad. How have you been? How's your week going? Is Nancy looking after you all right?

DAD: I'm fine, I'm fine… Aren't you home? Where are you? Where's your mother? Who's Nancy?

(a pause, a barely audible breath)

DAUGHTER (ADULT): …It's okay. I'll get in touch with Dr. Schrempp. Don't worry.

DAD: What do you mean? Where's your mother?

(silence)

DAUGHTER (ADULT): …Work has been really hectic this week. I'm sorry I haven't been able to come by.

DAD: Where are you? Where's your mother?

DAUGHTER (ADULT): …Don't worry, I'm just in the next town over. Not far at all. I promise.

DAD: And your mother?

(a longer silence; she changes the subject)

DAUGHTER (ADULT): …I really have to go, I'm sorry. My father-in-law fell down the steps last week and broke his leg, so I haven't been able to come and see you. I'll ask Nancy to take you to the park this weekend. I'll be there the week after. I promise.

DAD: …Where is your mother?

(long silence)

DAD: Hello?

(longer silence)

DAD: …I miss her.

DAUGHTER (ADULT): …I miss her too.

The call ends. Black. Three seconds of silence.

END CARD: "Wonder of You" in white on black. It fades in over 2 seconds, holds for 5 and fades out. Nothing else.

What the ending reveals

The last call quietly undoes everything the player believed that morning.

What Dad believed this morning	What is true
His wife is at work and called him twice.	She died years ago. Both calls came from his memory.
His daughter is a schoolgirl asleep down the hall.	She is a grown woman with a job and a husband, living one town over. The voice behind the door was the girl he remembers.
He has an appointment and should get himself there.	He has a caregiver, Nancy, and a doctor who manages his care.
The house is full.	He lives there alone.

His daughter never says her mother is dead, and he never fully understands. He still knows what he has lost, though: "I miss her." The film's idea lands there. The names and faces are gone, but the shape of loving someone is still there, for both of them.